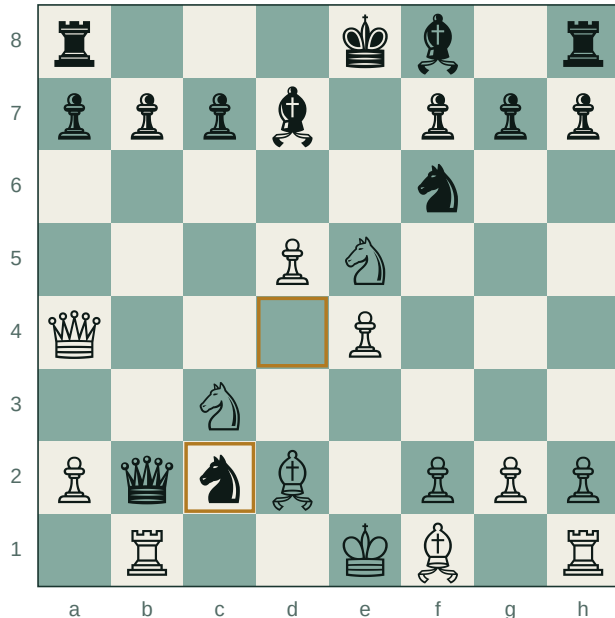


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 12

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 11...Nc2+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. Ke2 Qxb1 13. Nxd7

12.Ke2 The king moves from e1 to e2. Recorded reply: **12...Qxb1**.

13.Nxd7 The knight captures the bishop on d7. From d7 it attacks knight on f6 and bishop on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 32 / Black 34 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from +0 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: bishop on d7.